

Basic bidding Notrump raises Major suit raises

This set of practice deals focuses on basic bidding situations. There are no conventions used except for one deal which uses Blackwood. Even that is optional.

The deals are designed with the beginning player in mind, or perhaps those who feel the need to refresh themselves on the fundamentals of bidding.

The purpose of these deals is to provide practice in finding a fit and deciding whether to stop at a part score, bid game or bid slam.

Keep in mind:

- a combined 8-card trump fit is desired to play in a suit

- it takes 26 points to make game in Notrump or a Major suit

- it takes 33 points to make small slam

Board: 1

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 1NT

Declarer: North

Lead: ♠ 7

Board: 2

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 2 ♠

Declarer: East

Lead: ♥ 8

Board: 3

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 6NT

Declarer: South

Lead: ♠ 10

Board: 4

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: West

Lead: ♥ 4

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A 4 2
♥ 10 7 6 5 3
♦ 10 7 2
♣ A 3

♠ 10 9 5

♥ J 4

♦ Q J 8 3

♣ K J 7 2



♠ K Q 8 7

♥ 9

♦ A 9 5 4

♣ Q 8 6 4

♠ J 6 3

♥ A K Q 8 2

♦ K 6

♣ 10 9 5

SOUTH has a solid 1♥ opening, 14 points and five trumps.

NORTH must respond with 8 points, but cannot bid either minor suit since he needs at least 11 points to bid a new suit at the 2-level. So he bids 1NT (6-10 points).

SOUTH doesn't object to Notrump so she passes.

West	North	East	South
			1♥
Pass	1NT		
All Pass			
1NT by North			
Lead: ♠7			

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ J 9 6 2
♥ K Q 7 5
♦ 8 3
♣ 10 7 4

♠ 5

♥ J 10 9 3

♦ A 10 6 2

♣ K J 8 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K Q 10 7 3

♥ A 4 2

♦ 9 7 5

♣ A 6

♠ A 8 4

♥ 8 6

♦ K Q J 4

♣ Q 9 5 2

EAST has a normal 1♠ opening bid, 14 points and five trumps.

WEST has good 4-card support and 7 points, so she raises to 2♠, passed by EAST.

WEST does not consider showing the ♥s, first because she knows there is a ♠ fit, and second because she doesn't have the 11 points needed to bid a new suit at the 2-level.

*West**North**East**South*

1♠

Pass

2♠

All Pass

2♠ by East

Lead: ♥8

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q 10 9 7 6 5

♥ 6 3

♦ 8

♣ 7 6 3 2

♠ K J 4

♥ K Q 9 2

♦ A Q 5

♣ K 10 8



♠ 2

♥ J 10 8 5 4

♦ 10 7 3 2

♣ A 9 4

♠ A 8 3

♥ A 7

♦ K J 9 6 4

♣ Q J 5

With balanced distribution and 16 points SOUTH should open 1NT rather than 1♦.

NORTH's response is based on simple math. He adds his 18 points to the 15 minimum that SOUTH has announced and comes up with 33 points combined. This is enough for a small slam, and since he has balanced distribution he bids 6NT.

*West**North**East**South*

1NT

Pass

6NT

All Pass

6NT by South

Lead: ♠ 10

Board 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ K 4
 ♥ Q 10 6
 ♦ 8 5 3 2
 ♣ Q 9 8 5

♠ 5 3

♥ K 8 5 4 3

♦ K J 4

♣ 10 6 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q J 10 9 6

♥ A 7

♦ A Q 6

♣ A K 7

♠ A 8 7 2

♥ J 9 2

♦ 10 9 7

♣ J 3 2

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♠

Pass

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by West

Lead: ♥ 4

EAST is right at the maximum for a 1 ♠ opening bid - one more point and he would have opened 2 ♣.

WEST does not have 3-card ♠ support but with 7 points must make some response. She cannot bid at the 2-level so she says 1NT (6-10 points).

EAST is fine with Notrump so he bids 3NT.